Tobruk University
Faculty of Nursing

Research and Graduation Research Guide

Approved guide

NUR-MAN-RES-001

Edition 0.3

2026

Professional responsibilities, quality and continuous improvement

Published reading copy. Current legislation and university decisions govern implementation.

Contents

1. Scope and hierarchy of references

2. Responsibilities of the University and academic leadership

3. Responsibilities of the coordinator, supervisor, researcher, and supporting bodies

4. Translating the strategic plan into research work

5. Topic selection and allocation of supervision

6. Project cycle and approval gates

7. Ethics and protection of participants

8. Data, confidentiality, and integrity

9. Support, publication, funding, and ownership

10. Use of findings and measurement of work quality

11. Work register and required forms

Approval and updating items

References and points of reliance

Approved English edition.

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An expanded approved edition, building on version 0.1 and the existing operational guide. It organizes responsibilities, decisions, and records from research topic selection through verification that education and the community have benefited from the research. Authorized work continues; the organizational additions included here form part of this edition. Naming an ethics committee or administrative department in this guide does not establish one, nor does the guide confer on the Faculty Council a power reserved to the University or health authority.

This edition addresses gaps in standardizing forms, organizing approvals, and linking findings to beneficiary organizations identified in the 2025/2026 research report. Incomplete central indexing is not treated as evidence that existing research or research defenses are absent. [R1, R2]

The competent body maintains the adoption, effective-date and subsequent amendment records in the document register.

1. Scope and hierarchy of references

This guide applies to graduation research, research by faculty members and teaching assistants, and work bearing the Faculty's name or using its facilities or data. It covers literature reviews, field studies, health records, questionnaires, and joint projects. The nature of participation, data, and risks determines the approval pathway. A project is not automatically exempt because its sample is small or because it is a course assignment.

Refer first to national legislation in force and University decisions, then to the Ministry's academic reference and approved course specifications, and then to Faculty procedures within its authority. Article 2 of the regulations under Decision 430/2025 emphasizes linking activities and evaluation to the institution's mission and objectives, and the existence of research plans, policies, and funding sources and mechanisms for community and environmental service. Older regulatory references in the Ministry's guide are reviewed on that basis. Provisions governing postgraduate dissertations and theses are not automatically transferred to bachelor's research. [R3, R8]

Relevant accreditation requirements cover research management, priority setting, ethics, peer review, development of students' skills, support for publication and scholarly participation, and evaluation of research policy. Faculty and University responses are allocated according to authority. The Faculty is not assumed to need an independent journal or independent research funding arrangements to meet an institutional requirement. [R7]

2. Responsibilities of the University and academic leadership

The competent University bodies handle general policies, services, funding, contracts, scholarly recognition, and referral to the competent ethics body within their powers. The University guide allows the Research, Consultancy and Training Centre to support scientific cooperation, capacity

building, expertise, and resources, without attributing ethical-approval authority to it unless a decision establishing that authority is evidenced. [R4, pp. 66-67]

Within its authority, the Faculty Council approves priorities, monitoring mechanisms, and assignments, considers results, risks, and support needs, and refers matters beyond its authority to the University. The Dean identifies the implementing body, available resources, and correspondence pathway, follows up delayed decisions, and resolves conflicting assignments. The University's faculty-member guide requires committee composition, duties, and duration to be defined. The phrase “research committee” therefore does not replace a formation decision or a documented mandate. [R5]

Academic Affairs oversees the quality of the academic pathway, balances supervision workloads with teaching and clinical duties, proposes supervisor, reviewer, and examiner assignments, and reviews students' capacity, schedules, and instruments. The pathway through the Scientific Committee or equivalent body is to be confirmed according to the outcome of the ongoing verification of its formation decision and minutes. Technical preparation of proposals and specifications continues without attributing approval to that body before its supporting authority is complete. [R2, R6]

The competent academic Department Council sets teaching and research policy within its scope, implements quality programmes, monitors staff research and service to the University and community based on the Head of Department's report, discusses the Department's annual report, and proposes training and scientific agreements. The Head of Department implements its decisions and submits recommendations and reports through the approved pathway. The Faculty's operation of a single programme does not cancel these powers. Their correspondence to the existing department and its decisions is to be confirmed without assuming a new structure. [R10]

University President's Decision 219 of 2023 assigns the Vice Dean responsibility for following up department heads, completion of syllabus content, and quality control to improve services; identifying reference and laboratory needs; organizing events; and encouraging training. Here, that translates into reviewing research needs and supervision workloads, implementing development, and requesting support, without transferring research execution or ownership of its files from those responsible for them. [R11]

3. Responsibilities of the coordinator, supervisor, researcher, and supporting bodies

The title “Research Coordinator” in this guide describes an assigned role and does not create a post. The coordinator gathers the minimum data from its owners. The supervisor remains responsible for the validity of academically endorsed work, and authorized bodies remain responsible for approvals. Monitoring covers both staff research and student research, with the two categories separated in statistics. [R1, R2]

Party	Duty in research quality and implementation of the plan	Output and verification frequency
Department Council and Head of Department	Discuss research priorities, staff performance, needs, and results within their scope; propose cooperation and support; and submit recommendations. The Head of Department links this to the annual report and	Minutes, recommendation, and departmental report; according to Council meetings and the annual cycle.

Party	Duty in research quality and implementation of the plan	Output and verification frequency
	implementation of Council decisions.	
Officer assigned responsibility for research	Records the idea, supervisor, stages, and approvals; follows up deadlines; identifies support needs; and links the project to a research priority and beneficiary. Alerts Academic Affairs to delays or conflicts without independently changing a topic or result.	A register updated at transitions between stages; an annual report drawing its data from project files.
Academic supervisor	Reviews the question, methodology, sample, instrument, and analysis plan; verifies ethical and fieldwork readiness before collection; and provides documented feedback. Reviews originality, the limits of conclusions, and completion of amendments arising from the defense, and guides the transfer of findings.	Sign-off on academic review and a progress record at each milestone; final version and resolved comments.
Principal researcher or student team	Submits a realistic plan and disclosure of interests, allocates work, implements the authorized version and safeguards data, reports changes or risks, and attests to the accuracy of outputs and team contributions. Does not delegate responsibility to a digital tool or someone outside the team.	Proposal, instrument, approvals, contribution record, controlled data, and a reviewable result.
Reviewers and examiners	Disclose conflicts of interest, review using a clear method, provide actionable comments, and separate academic judgment from personal relationships. Record assessment and amendments using the course form without imposing new weightings.	A dated review report or defense minutes; verification for each project.
Healthcare site or data-holding body	Identifies the contact point, authorized access, data scope, patient protection, and safety pathway. Issues site permission in its competent capacity. This permission does not replace required ethical approval, nor does ethical approval replace site permission.	Permission with a specified scope and duration; access or data-handover record to the extent necessary.
Community Service, Training, and the Programme	Identify a realistic need, review the usability of findings, receive specific recommendations, and agree on a suitable implementation trial or activity. Verify the effect of use on service or learning without generalizing findings from a limited sample.	Referral, response, evidence of use, and suitable measurement; at project closure and the agreed follow-up.
Library, Information Technology, and Administration	Facilitate licensed resources, institutional storage, access permissions, training, and support, and refer financial needs to the University. Manage handover when a staff member or supervisor changes and document	Access to a source, account, or resource, with evidence of authorized use; according to requests and access-permission reviews.

Party	Duty in research quality and implementation of the plan	Output and verification frequency
	obstacles that impede research.	
Quality Assurance Department	Reviews procedural consistency and indicator definitions, verifies completeness of evidence through sampling, analyzes delays, and follows up improvement decisions. Does not approve methodology or ethics and does not retain a database of participants' names for calculating indicators.	Analysis, verification observation, and closure follow-up; within the semester cycle and existing annual report.

4. Translating the strategic plan into research work

The strategic plan updated on 13 October 2026 links research to the applied research and community health behavior axis, and to education, training, partnerships, and resources. A field for the initiative and its required outcome is added to the project register without creating a parallel plan or report. The plan's codes and indicators provide the monitoring links; baselines, targets and subsequent changes are maintained in the plan register. [R9]

Initiative in the strategic plan	Implementation and output	Measurement and follow-up
S3.1 Updating research priorities	Academic Affairs gathers the Programme's, Training's, and community's needs and proposes an achievable list alongside the supervision workload.	Reviewed annually; the quality of project files is linked to indicator K09.
S3.2 Methodological quality and research ethics	Supervisors apply proposal review, the approval gate, and the defense-readiness checklist.	K09; fulfillment of each element is substantiated by its reference, rather than relying only on the name of a completed project.
S3.3 Use of findings with beneficiary organizations	The researcher and Community Service or Training identify a usable recommendation and request a documented response.	K10; verified use annually, rather than merely sending the summary.
S3.4 Archiving and staff research development	The coordinator standardizes the file index. Academic Affairs and Faculty Affairs link training to supervisors' needs.	K09 for file completeness and K13 for evidence of applying a skill after training.

5. Topic selection and allocation of supervision

The cycle starts by reviewing the previous year's results: what was completed, what was delayed, and what could not be implemented because of data, time, or supervision constraints. Training providers and Community Service submit their needs. Academic Affairs reviews their alignment with University and national priorities where relevant documents are available, then presents a realistic

priority list. Students are not all restricted to one topic, and research numbers exceeding available supervision capacity are not approved.

The team submits an idea form defining the problem, question, population, site, feasibility, initial risks, and beneficiary. The supervisor checks resource availability and access to data before any fieldwork commitment. Supervision assignments, reallocation, reasons, and file handover are documented, and students are informed of the support-request pathway. Plan preparation and implementation are linked to the Nursing Research 1 and 2 specifications and their approved assessment weightings. [R2, R3]

6. Project cycle and approval gates

A project does not progress between stages merely because a calendar deadline has passed. The coordinator records the status as “Complete,” “Requires completion,” or “Deferred,” with the reason and responsible person, and escalates matters requiring higher authority. A substantial change to the sample, instrument, site, or method of access to data is reviewed before implementation. [R1, R2]

Stage	Work and responsible party	Progression condition and evidence
Registration	The team and supervisor define the idea, initial methodology, resources, and allocation of work; the coordinator records the project number.	A completed form and preliminary academic acceptance, which alone do not authorize data collection.
Proposal review	The supervisor and specialist reviewer examine the background, objectives, sample, instrument, analysis, risks, schedule, and data plan.	An identified version, addressed comments, and academic approval according to authority.
Approvals	Through Academic Affairs, the team follows the pathway for the authorized ethics body, site permission, and data access.	An approval or exemption decision from a competent body, and necessary site permissions before collection.
Implementation	The team implements the project, and the supervisor verifies collection quality and progress; changes and problems are reported.	Progress record, a copy of the instrument used, and decisions on any amendments; no retrospective approval.
Defense	The supervisor reviews completeness; assessors apply the approved instrument, and comments and the result are recorded.	Minutes, assessment, assignments, and follow-up of amendments; results proceed through academic approval channels.
Closure and use	The supervisor confirms completion of amendments; the coordinator indexes the final version; the beneficiary reviews recommendations.	An academically closed file and a summary for sharing, while follow-up of use remains open where needed.

7. Ethics and protection of participants

Academic Affairs confirms the name of the authorized ethical-review body, its application procedure, and the date and validity of its approval, in coordination with the University and site. Approval of the guide, acceptance of the project, or a facilitation letter does not replace that approval. A determination by the competent body that the work does not require review or is exempt is retained. The supervisor does not grant this exception independently.

Participant information explains the purpose, procedures, risks, voluntary participation, and a means of making inquiries. Consent is implemented in the form approved by the competent body. Agreement to participate is not tied to a grade, treatment, or employment benefit, and power relationships are considered when involving students, patients, or employees. The right to withdraw and limits on withdrawing data after anonymization are explained in accordance with the approved plan.

Research involving children and groups requiring additional protection is referred to the competent body to determine guardian consent, appropriate participant assent or consent, and protective requirements. The affected part is stopped if harm or a confidentiality breach occurs, and the supervisor and competent body are notified promptly. People's safety is addressed before forms are completed. This document does not provide a treatment protocol or an ethical determination on behalf of the authorized body. [R1, R7]

8. Data, confidentiality, and integrity

The data plan specifies what is collected, why, who can access it, where it is stored, how it is backed up, and when it is destroyed according to the approved reference. Only the minimum necessary data is collected, and coding is used where sufficient, with the key kept separate from the analysis. Patient records, identifiers, or images are not transferred to a personal account or unauthorized platform. Quality Assurance receives a statement of approval and file status and appropriate supporting evidence without copying raw data.

The team documents sources and members' contributions. Fabrication, alteration of results, and citation of unverified references are prohibited. Interests and the reviewer's relationship to the team are disclosed, and an alternative reviewer is appointed if independence is affected. Authorship and publication are agreed according to the academic body's rules; names are not added merely because of position. Similarity reports are reviewed academically, and misconduct is not inferred automatically from a single unapproved percentage.

Use of digital and artificial-intelligence tools is disclosed according to University and course policy. The researcher verifies the accuracy of information, analysis, and references. Restricted data is not uploaded to such tools without institutional authorization, and their outputs are not evidence that an experiment or interview occurred. An allegation of a breach is handled confidentially, with an opportunity to respond and referral to the competent body. This guide does not introduce a penalty. [R1, R5, R7]

9. Support, publication, funding, and ownership

Academic Affairs gathers needs relating to resources, methodology, statistics, and writing, and allocates training opportunities fairly and in a way suited to workloads. A beneficiary is asked for appropriate evidence of application, such as an improved instrument or analysis plan, rather than

only an attendance certificate. The coordinator records staff outputs, published contributions, and conference participation without counting work twice or attributing output that has not been issued.

Before submission, the publication venue, its suitability and policy, authors' rights, data, and conflicts of interest are reviewed. Official participation, research leave, and promotion follow the University pathways set out in the faculty-member guide and regulations in force. The guide does not introduce benefits or rewards. Agreements specify data rights, ownership, authorship, publication, responsibilities, and termination before exchanges with a partner. [R4, R5]

A request for funding, a subscription, or equipment is submitted with a justification, priority, and expected output through Administration and the University, distinguishing request, approval, disbursement, and use. Supporting documents remain with their owner. No unsubstantiated amount is recorded, and financial independence of the Faculty is not assumed. Contracts, financial commitments, and disposal of property are referred to authorized bodies.

Research outputs and citations are monitored through an annual register with a defined cut-off date. It records the researcher, publication, type, year, identifier or link, indexing database, citation source, and measurement date. Names and identifiers are reconciled and duplicates removed. Citation counts from different databases are not combined into one figure without a stated method. Coverage limits, publication age, and disciplinary differences are stated; the count does not become a sole judgment of a researcher's quality. Where verification is not possible, the value is described accordingly rather than estimated from memory. [R12]

10. Use of findings and measurement of work quality

The project summary includes the limits of the sample and methodology, supported findings, the recommendation, and the organization that could use it. The beneficiary reviews suitability, resources, and risks before implementation. The coordinator records dispatch, response, use, and verification of the result as separate stages. Delivery of a summary or publication of an activity photograph does not establish a change in behavior or service.

K09 is calculated as projects meeting the requirements for methodological and ethical review, final version, and defense, divided by projects due for closure during the period. Non-applicability of an ethical requirement is evidenced by a decision of the competent body and is not silently omitted. K10 is measured by the number of findings or recommendations with documented use, with the unit defined to avoid counting the same finding twice. A staff skill applied after development is linked to K13. [R9] K13 is calculated as participants who provided evidence of applying a targeted skill after development, divided by participants required to be followed up, multiplied by one hundred, according to the plan's definition.

The annual report presents the numerator, denominator, period, source, and data limitations, and separates student research, staff output, and deferred projects. Missing data is shown as unavailable, not replaced with zero. Academic Affairs and Quality Assurance review reasons for delays and options for addressing them. The Council or competent authority specifies the decision, responsible person, deadline, and evidence for verifying its effect. Closing correspondence alone does not resolve a research-quality problem.

11. Work register and required forms

Forms are completed within the existing document system and linked to the project file rather than repeating data in several registers. One file with multiple sections may be used to cover the fields

below. The approval decision specifies the authorized person, actual pathway, and operative version. [R1, R2]

A research-ethics procedure and a proposal-approval procedure already exist. Their owners use the gates in this guide to complete the responsible person, required document, escalation, and progression condition. The review noted that NUR-PRO-RES-002 is used for two different documents: proposal approval and monitoring outputs and citations. The document-control owner resolves the unique code with the owners of both procedures in the central register, recording references and previous versions. The original is not silently renamed or merged. [R12, R13, R14]

Form or register	Minimum fields
Project form	Code; category; title; team and supervisor; question; priority and initiative; site; risks; resources; beneficiary; schedule.
Review and approvals	Proposal and instrument version; reviewer and capacity; comments and response; ethics body, its decision, and validity; site permission; readiness date.
Progress and change	Stage; completed work; obstacle; proposed amendment; its effect; who reviews and authorizes it; duration; version used; completion evidence.
Defense and closure	Assessors and disclosure; marks form; minutes; amendments; supervisor verification; final version; summary; restricted-storage link.
Use and improvement	Recommendation; beneficiary; dispatch and response; use; evidence of the result and its limits; indicator; improvement decision; owner and deadline.

Approval and updating items

• Confirm the research owner, academic pathway, authorized ethics body, and names of operative forms, without assuming an unverified committee.

• Approve a mechanism linking each project to its priority, initiative, and beneficiary, and approve indicator definitions with the final version of the plan.

• Define data-access, retention, destruction, and institutional-handover permissions, and refer rights, funding, and agreements to the University according to authority.

• Reconcile the defense pathway, marks, and reviewer assignments with course specifications and regulations in force before circulating an operational version.

• Resolve the RES002 code conflict and issue controlled versions of the proposal, ethics, and output-monitoring procedures, preserving each document's identity and history.

References and points of reliance

[R1] Faculty research guide, previous operational edition

Location: items 4-13 | Status: previous working reference; does not replace assignment decisions and approvals.

[R2] Updated annual report on research and graduation research activities, 2025/2026

Location: summary; sections 5-8; allocation of responsibilities | Status: updated work report; its data are reconciled with the originals.

[R3] Revised nursing faculties guide, 2021-2022

Location: Articles 5 and 8; Nursing Research 1 and 2 specifications | Status: supplied Ministry reference; organizational provisions are checked against the national reference in force.

[R4] Tobruk University guide, July 2025

Location: Research, Consultancy and Training Centre, pp. 66-67 | Status: supplied University guide.

[R5] Tobruk University faculty-member guide, July 2025

Location: committee formation; conferences; research leave; performance evaluation | Status: supplied University guide; rights and figures are checked against decisions in force.

[R6] Implementation and follow-up guide for the directive concerning the Scientific Committee

Location: sections 4-9 and the pathway for the search outcome | Status: updated internal working reference; does not by itself establish a committee formation decision.

[R7] Institutional accreditation standards, fourth edition, 2023

Location: Standard 7, indicators 1-20; Standard 2, ethical charter | Status: supplied accreditation reference.

[R8] Council of Ministers Decision No. 430 of 2025 approving the executive regulations of Law No. 4 of 2020

Location: regulations, Article 2, seventh subsection, p. 4; complete Article 2 on pp. 2-4 | Status: scanned original available; Article 2, Articles 48-66, and the signed page were verified during the review. Inspection is not generalized to the entire regulations. Source filename, translated: Council of Ministers Decision No. (430) of 2025 approving the executive regulations of Universities Law No. (4) of 2020.pdf.

[R9] Strategic plan 2026-2030, updated 13 October 2026

Location: Strategic_Plan_2026_2030_Expert_Draft_20261013.docx; S3.1-S3.4; K09, K10, and K13; links to the training and partnerships axes | Status: plan reference; baselines, targets and changes are maintained in the plan register.

[R10] Law No. 4 of 2020 amending the Universities Law, Official Gazette copy

Location: Article 31, particularly items 1, 10, 12, 15, 16, and 19; Article 33 | Status: Official Gazette copy; the provisions on authority were read in the text and their images verified during reference review.

[R11] Tobruk University President's Decision No. 219 of 2023 on the duties of Vice Deans for Academic Affairs in faculties

Location: Article 1, items 2, 4, 5, 6, 8, and 9 | Status: scanned original visually verified; older legislative references are checked against newer regulations.

[R12] Procedure for monitoring research outputs and citations

Location: items 3-9 | Status: existing procedure; RES002 is duplicated with another procedure and requires resolution.

[R13] Research proposal approval procedure

Location: purpose and procedural steps | Status: brief procedure; RES002 requires resolution.

[R14] Research ethics procedure

Location: purpose, steps, and storage | Status: brief procedure; its implementation records specify the approval gates and authorized body.